



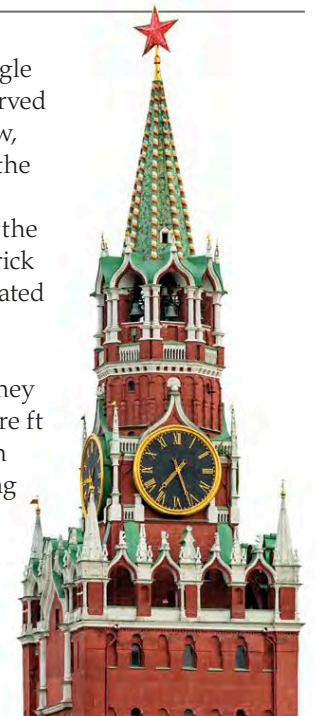
The Kremlin

The symbolic heart of Russian power for over 600 years

The Moscow Kremlin is a fortified triangle on the banks of the River Moskva that served as the seat of the Grand Dukes of Moscow, the residence of the Russian czars, and the home of the Soviet leaders, and is now the official residence of the President of the Russian Federation. Its crenellated, red brick walls, 1.5 miles (2.5 km) long and punctuated by 20 towers, were built at the end of the 15th century at the request of Ivan III (the Great), Grand Prince of Moscow. They enclose an area of nearly 3,200,000 square ft (300,000 square m), within which are an eclectic assemblage of buildings, including three cathedrals and four palaces.

Fusion of styles

The Kremlin's architecture ranges from the simple white, Italianate-Byzantine beauty of the 15th-century Cathedral of the Assumption built for the Grand Prince, to the 17th-century Moscow Classical-style Senate building built in the reign of Catherine the Great, and the Modernist glass and concrete Soviet-era State Kremlin Palace.



△ POWERFUL PORTAL

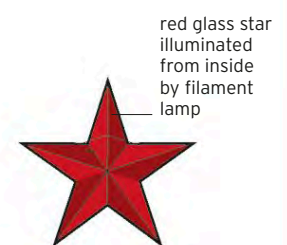
The *Spasskaya* ("savior") Tower, once the Kremlin's main entrance, was believed to have the power to protect the Kremlin from invaders.

EAGLES AND STARS

After the 1917 Russian Revolution, the Soviet leaders wanted to destroy all imperial symbols. In 1935, they removed the metalwork imperial eagles from four of the Kremlin's towers and replaced them with red five-pointed stars. The original stars soon dulled and were replaced with 1-ton (0.9-tonne) glass stars measuring up to 12 ft (3.75 m) across that light up and revolve.



DOUBLE-HEADED EAGLE



KREMLIN STAR

A "kremlin" is a **fortified complex** within a town; **five Russian kremlins**, including the one in Moscow, are **UNESCO World Heritage Sites**

◁ COLORFUL CATHEDRAL

Frescoes of Biblical scenes and saints' lives cover the interior of the Kremlin's Dormition Cathedral, the coronation church of Russian monarchs from 1547 to 1896.